BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Module 4C — Connect Your AI CEO to Discord

Invite Your Bot, Configure Discord, and Connect It to OpenClaw

MODULE 4C — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Step-by-Step Student Setup Guide — Mac and Windows (WSL2)

What You'll Accomplish

In Module 3, you created your Discord server, six communication channels, and your AI CEO's Discord bot.

In Module 4A, you installed OpenClaw.

In Module 4B, you installed your AI CEO's personalized files into its workspace.

Now it's time to connect OpenClaw to Discord.

By the end of this lesson, you will have:

- Invited your Discord bot into your server
- Confirmed its permissions and Message Content Intent
- Saved your Discord Bot Token securely
- Added your Server ID, personal User ID, and six Channel IDs to OpenClaw
- Checked and applied your configuration
- Validated your settings before First Contact

> ***Important:*** *We are not starting the gateway or sending messages to your AI CEO in this lesson. That happens in Module 4D.*

Before You Start

Have the following ready from Module 3:

- Your Discord Bot Token
- Your Discord Server ID
- Your personal Discord User ID
- Your six Discord Channel IDs

Your six channels should be:

- `#operator`
- `#morning-brief`
- `#bugs`
- `#content`
- `#strategy`
- `#nightly-review`

You should also have completed the OpenClaw setup wizard and Module 4B.

Important Security Reminder

Your Discord Bot Token is like a password for your bot.

Never share it in Discord messages, screenshots, AI chats, or public support requests.

We will store the token in a local environment file rather than typing it directly into OpenClaw's main configuration.

How to Use This Guide

Whenever you see a Terminal command:

1. Copy the entire command
2. Open Terminal on your Mac, or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows
3. Paste the command
4. Press Enter
5. Wait for the result before continuing

Use straight quotation marks in commands, not curly quotation marks.

> ***Windows users:*** *These instructions are for Ubuntu running through WSL2, not native Windows PowerShell.*

Step 1 — Invite Your Discord Bot Into Your Server

Creating a Discord bot in the Developer Portal does not automatically add it to your server. You must invite it.

1. Open the Discord Developer Portal

Go to:

> `https://discord.com/developers/applications`

Sign in to your Discord account if prompted.

You should see the application you created in Module 3. Click your bot's application. For example, if you named your AI CEO Cyrus, select that application.

2. Confirm Your Bot Settings

In the left sidebar, click **Bot**.

Confirm that:

- Your bot has the name you selected
- **Public Bot** is turned **ON** so you can complete the bot invitation process
- **Message Content Intent** is turned **ON** under Privileged Gateway Intents so your AI CEO can read messages

Save changes if Discord provides a Save Changes button.

> ***Important:*** *Having Public Bot turned ON does not automatically make your Discord server or conversations public. It controls whether other Discord users can add your bot to servers they manage.*
> *We'll restrict who can interact with your AI CEO through OpenClaw's Discord configuration, using your personal User ID and approved channels.*
> *Do not reset your bot token unless you lost it or believe it was exposed. Resetting a token invalidates the old one.*

3. Generate Your Bot Invitation Link

In the left sidebar, open **OAuth2 → URL Generator**.

Under **Scopes**, select:

- `bot`
- `applications.commands`

The second scope supports Discord application commands.

Under **Bot Permissions**, select:

- View Channels
- Send Messages
- Read Message History
- Embed Links
- Attach Files

If Discord shows Use Application Commands, you can select that as well.

You do not need to grant Administrator permission.

> ***Important:*** *Discord's Developer Portal may show an Installation page instead of, or alongside, the OAuth2 URL Generator. If you're using the Installation page, choose a server installation with the* `bot` *and* `applications.commands` *scopes and the same permissions.*

4. Invite Your Bot

Copy the generated installation or invitation URL.

Open a new browser tab. Paste the URL and press Enter. It may take a few seconds.

Discord will ask which server you want to add the bot to. Select the Discord server you created in Module 3.

Click **Continue** or the equivalent button, review the requested permissions, and click **Authorize**. Complete any CAPTCHA if prompted.

You must have permission to add applications to that server.

5. Confirm Your Bot Joined

Open Discord and click your server.

Look for the Member List on the right side. If you don't see it, click the Member List icon near the top-right corner.

Look for your AI CEO's bot name. It may appear under **Bots** or **Offline**.

If you see your bot — your bot has successfully joined your Discord server.

If your bot appears Offline, that's normal. We haven't started its OpenClaw connection yet.

6. Confirm Channel Permissions

Make sure the bot can access the six channels you created.

For each channel:

1. Right-click the channel
2. Open **Edit Channel → Permissions**

3. Review the permissions for your bot or the role assigned to it
4. Confirm that it can **View Channel**, **Send Messages**, and **Read Message History**

> ***Remember:*** *Channel-specific permission overrides can restrict a bot even when its server-level permissions look correct. You do not need to make your channels public.*

Step 2 — Save Your Discord Bot Token Securely

Now we're going to store your Discord Bot Token where OpenClaw can access it.

1. Open Your Environment File

Open Terminal on your Mac or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows.

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
nano ~/.openclaw/.env
```

This opens a simple text editor inside Terminal. The file is called `.env` and is used to store environment settings, including certain credentials.

2. Add Your Bot Token

Inside the editor, add the following line:

```
DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_REAL_BOT_TOKEN_HERE
```

Replace `PASTE_YOUR_REAL_BOT_TOKEN_HERE` with the actual Discord Bot Token you saved in Module 3.

For example, your completed line may resemble this:

```
DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN=MTIzNDU2Nzg5MDEyMzQ1Njc4.FAKE99.ExampleTokenOnly1234567890AbCdEf
```

This is a fictional example token. It will not connect to Discord.

Important:

- Do not add spaces around the equals sign
- Do not add quotation marks around the token
- If `.env` already contains other settings, leave them in place

- Never share your actual token

3. Save Your Changes

Press these keys in order:

- `Control + O` — Save
- `Enter` — Confirm the filename
- `Control + X` — Exit nano

You should now be back at your normal Terminal prompt.

4. Restrict Access to the File

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
chmod 600 ~/.openclaw/.env
```

This limits file access to the owner account on the Linux/macOS filesystem.

> ***Important:*** *This does not encrypt your token. Anyone with sufficient access to your computer or account may still be able to read it.*

Your Discord token is now saved locally.

Step 3 — Prepare Your Discord Configuration File

Next, we'll create a small configuration patch containing your Discord settings.

This is not your main OpenClaw configuration file. Think of it as a set of instructions telling OpenClaw which Discord server, user, and channels to allow. We will apply these settings to the existing configuration created during installation.

1. Create Your Setup File

Open Terminal. Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
nano ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5
```

A blank editor should open. Leave it open for now.

2. Copy the Discord Configuration Template

Copy the entire template below into a plain-text editor on your computer. You do this by opening a pages document, saving it to your desktop, click file, export as, then plain text. Save that to your desktop and open it. Paste the below template into that document.

- **Mac:** You can use TextEdit with Format → Make Plain Text.
- **Windows:** You can use Notepad.

```
{
  channels: {
    discord: {
      enabled: true,

      token: {
        source: "env",
        provider: "default",
        id: "DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN"
      },

      dmPolicy: "disabled",
      dm: {
        enabled: false
      },

      groupPolicy: "allowlist",
      joinIntro: false,

      guilds: {
        "SERVER_ID": {
          requireMention: false,

          users: ["YOUR_USER_ID"],

          channels: {
            "OPERATOR_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true },
            "MORNING_BRIEF_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true },
            "BUGS_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true },
            "CONTENT_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true },
            "STRATEGY_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true },
            "NIGHTLY_REVIEW_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true }
          }
        }
      }
    }
  }
}
```

What this template does:

- `enabled: true` — Enables Discord in OpenClaw
- `token` — Tells OpenClaw to use the token saved in your environment file
- `dmPolicy: "disabled"` — Disables Discord direct-message access for this beginner setup
- `groupPolicy: "allowlist"` — Restricts Discord access to approved servers
- `joinIntro: false` — Prevents an automatic introductory message when the bot connects
- `guilds` — Identifies your approved Discord server
- `requireMention: false` — Allows messages in approved channels without tagging the bot every time
- `users` — Restricts who can interact with your AI CEO to your personal Discord account
- `channels` — Limits interaction to the six channels you specify

> ***Security note:*** *Because the bot can respond without an @mention in the allowed channels, keep your personal User ID restriction in place. Only add other trusted users deliberately.*

3. Replace the Placeholders With Your Discord IDs

You collected these numbers in Module 3. Now replace the placeholders in your template with your actual IDs.

There are **eight placeholders** to replace.

Example:

Suppose your `#operator` channel ID is `123456789012345678`. You would change:

```
"OPERATOR_CHANNEL_ID": { enabled: true }
```

To:

```
"123456789012345678": { enabled: true }
```

Repeat this process for all six channels.

Important — Before You Continue

Double-check the following:

- [ ] You replaced all eight placeholders
- [ ] You used your **personal** Discord User ID, not the bot's User ID
- [ ] You used the correct Server ID
- [ ] Each Channel ID matches the correct channel

- [ ] You did not type channel names or include `#` symbols
- [ ] You kept quotation marks around each ID
- [ ] You used straight quotation marks
- [ ] You left all other punctuation and brackets unchanged

> ***Do not replace `DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN` in the template.*** *That is the name of the environment variable you created in Step 2, not a placeholder for the actual token.*

4. Paste Your Completed Configuration Into Terminal

Once you've edited the template:

1. Select and copy the entire completed configuration
2. Return to the Terminal window where nano is open
3. Paste the configuration into nano

You should see your completed Discord configuration with your Server ID, personal User ID, and all six Channel IDs.

5. Save Your Setup File

Press:

- `Control + O`
- `Enter`
- `Control + X`

Your configuration patch is now saved.

> ***Important:*** *You have not changed OpenClaw's main configuration yet. That happens in Step 6.*

Step 4 — Check Your Discord Information

Before applying anything, take a moment to confirm that the Discord information you entered is correct.

1. Confirm Your Server and Channel IDs

Open Discord and compare your saved IDs against the configuration you just created.

Make sure:

- Your Server ID belongs to the correct server

- Your personal User ID belongs to your account
- Each of the six Channel IDs belongs to its corresponding channel

If you need to copy an ID again:

1. Open Discord Settings
2. Enable Developer Mode if it isn't already enabled
3. Right-click the server, channel, or your own profile
4. Select the appropriate **Copy ID** option

2. Check the Setup File Again

In Terminal, copy and run:

```
▷  TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

nano ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5
```

Review the IDs and punctuation. If you make any corrections, save them using:

- `Control + O`
- `Enter`
- `Control + X`

If everything looks correct, exit using `Control + X`.

3. Understand What the Six Channels Do

These channels give you organized places to communicate with your AI CEO:

- `#operator` — General instructions and conversations
- `#morning-brief` — A place for future daily briefings
- `#bugs` — Errors, issues, and troubleshooting
- `#content` — Content creation and marketing work
- `#strategy` — Business planning and strategic discussions
- `#nightly-review` — A place for future end-of-day reporting

> ***Important:*** *Creating and allowing these channels does not automatically schedule messages or make the AI CEO behave differently in each channel. Those workflows and automations will be configured separately.*

Step 5 — Stop the OpenClaw Gateway Temporarily

Before changing OpenClaw's configuration, we'll make sure its managed gateway is stopped. This is a temporary step — we're not uninstalling OpenClaw or deleting anything.

1. Open Terminal

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw gateway stop
```

2. Wait for the Result

If the gateway stops successfully, continue. If it was already stopped, that's okay.

If OpenClaw reports that no managed gateway service is installed, review the gateway installation from Module 4A before proceeding.

> ***Important:*** *OpenClaw's configuration-writing commands require the gateway to be stopped. Do not skip this step if your gateway is running.*

Step 6 — Preview Your Discord Configuration

Now we're going to check your setup file before making any changes to OpenClaw. This is called a **dry run** — it checks the proposed configuration without saving it to the main configuration file.

1. Run the Preview

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config patch --file ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5 --dry-run
```

2. Review the Result

If OpenClaw reports that the dry run succeeded, you're ready to continue.

If you see an error, stop here. Do not apply the configuration until the error is resolved.

3. Fix Errors if Necessary

To reopen your setup file, run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
nano ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5
```

Check:

- All eight placeholders were replaced
- Every ID is inside straight quotation marks
- The commas, braces, and brackets are intact
- You did not accidentally delete any part of the template
- The environment variable name is still `DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN`

Save any corrections, then rerun the dry-run command.

Do not proceed until the dry run succeeds.

Step 7 — Apply Your Discord Configuration

Now we're ready to add your Discord settings to OpenClaw.

1. Apply the Setup File

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config patch --file ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5
```

Press Enter. Wait for OpenClaw to finish.

This merges your Discord settings into the existing OpenClaw configuration. It does not replace the entire configuration file with the small template.

> ***Important:*** *The patch merges objects but replaces individual values and arrays at the paths included in the patch. Review any existing Discord settings before applying it if you previously configured another bot or server.*

2. Confirm the Settings Were Saved

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config get channels.discord.guilds
```

You should see your Discord Server ID and the six Channel IDs you configured. Compare the numbers to your Module 3 notes and make sure they match.

3. Validate OpenClaw's Configuration

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config validate
```

If OpenClaw reports that your configuration is valid — your Discord settings have been applied successfully.

If validation fails, read the error and resolve it before moving on.

You can also run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw doctor
```

This can help identify installation or configuration problems.

> ***Important:*** *A valid configuration does not prove that the bot can connect or that the AI model will respond. We'll test those in Module 4D.*

Step 8 — Final Discord Connection Checklist

Before moving on, confirm that you've completed everything in this lesson.

- [ ] My Discord bot has been invited to my server
- [ ] I can see my bot in the Discord member list
- [ ] Message Content Intent is enabled
- [ ] My bot has the necessary channel permissions

- [ ] My real Discord Bot Token is saved in `~/.openclaw/.env`
- [ ] I restricted access to the environment file
- [ ] I created my Discord configuration patch
- [ ] I replaced all eight ID placeholders
- [ ] My personal Discord User ID is correct
- [ ] All six Channel IDs match the correct channels
- [ ] I stopped the gateway before editing the configuration
- [ ] My configuration dry run succeeded
- [ ] I applied the configuration successfully
- [ ] I verified my saved Discord settings
- [ ] `openclaw config validate` completed successfully

Congratulations — Your Discord Configuration Is Ready!

Your Discord bot is now a member of your server. OpenClaw has been configured to use your bot token and recognize your approved server, user, and six channels.

The final connection test is still ahead.

Troubleshooting

Problem: I can't see my bot in Discord

Check that you completed the invitation process in Step 1. Return to the Developer Portal and verify the installation settings. Make sure you selected the correct Discord server and authorized the installation.

Your bot may appear Offline until OpenClaw connects.

Problem: My bot can't access a channel

Open the channel's permission settings in Discord. Confirm that your bot can View Channel, Send Messages, and Read Message History. Check for permission overrides that might deny access.

Problem: My configuration dry run fails

Reopen your setup file:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
nano ~/.openclaw/discord-setup.patch.json5
```

Check the JSON5 formatting and all eight IDs. Also verify that your token was saved in the `.env` file. Do not paste your actual token into the configuration template.

Problem: OpenClaw reports a configuration error

Run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config validate
```

Then, if needed:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw doctor
```

Read the error before making changes. Do not replace the entire wizard-generated configuration with a new template.

Problem: My bot token isn't working

Check that you copied the correct token from the Discord Developer Portal. Make sure it was entered correctly in `~/.openclaw/.env`.

If you reset your token in Discord, the previous token will no longer work. Update the environment file with the new token. Do not share your token while troubleshooting.

Problem: The bot is visible but doesn't respond

At this stage, that is expected. We have not started the gateway or performed First Contact yet. We'll test the full connection in Module 4D.

If the bot still doesn't respond after starting the gateway, we'll check its connection status, channel permissions, allowed IDs, and AI model authentication.

⚡ Time Hack: Use ChatGPT to Fill This In Faster

If Terminal displays a confusing message or error, you can use ChatGPT to help you understand it. You don't need to become a programmer to troubleshoot your AI CEO.

Here's what to do:

1. Copy the error message from Terminal
2. Remove any Discord Bot Tokens, API keys, passwords, or other sensitive information
3. Open ChatGPT
4. Paste the cleaned error message along with the prompt below

Copy and paste this prompt into ChatGPT:

> *I'm a complete beginner setting up my own AI CEO using OpenClaw and Discord. I've installed Node.js and OpenClaw, created my personalized workspace files, and I'm now configuring Discord. I'm following Module 4C of the Build Your AI CEO course.*
>
> *I encountered the following Terminal output:*
>
> *[PASTE YOUR TERMINAL OUTPUT HERE — REMOVE ALL PRIVATE KEYS AND TOKENS FIRST]*
>
> *I'm using [Mac / Windows with WSL2].*
>
> *Please act as a patient technical support expert and:*
> *1. Explain in simple, nontechnical language what this output means*
> *2. Tell me whether it's a normal message, warning, or actual error*
> *3. Identify the most likely cause without making unsupported assumptions*
> *4. Give me the safest troubleshooting step and the exact Terminal command to copy and paste if needed*
> *5. Explain what I should expect to see after that step*
>
> *Please give me only ONE troubleshooting step at a time and wait for my response before continuing. Do not ask me to reveal credentials, delete files, or overwrite my existing OpenClaw configuration. If a command may have changed in newer versions of OpenClaw, tell me to verify it against the official documentation.*

Pro tip: You can continue using the same ChatGPT conversation throughout your setup so ChatGPT can follow the troubleshooting steps you've already completed.

> ***Security reminder:*** *If you accidentally expose a real token or API key, revoke or rotate it through the service that issued it. Removing it from a chat or screenshot does not make an exposed credential safe again.*

Up Next — Module 4D: First Contact

Your AI CEO's workspace files are installed. Your Discord bot has joined your server. Your Discord settings are saved and validated.

Now it's time to bring everything online.

In the next lesson, we'll:

- Start the OpenClaw gateway
- Check the gateway and Discord connection status
- Confirm that your AI CEO is ready to receive messages
- Send your first message in Discord
- Meet your AI CEO for the first time

You're almost there!